The 2026 State of Internet English, Regional Slang & Workplace Pragmatics Report

Empirical Breakdown of Semantic Lanes, Transatlantic US/UK/Irish Usage, and Register Shift (CC BY 4.0)

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All SlangLane Academic Working Papers & PDFs: https://slanglane.com/papers

Interactive ESL Teacher Kit & Quiz Maker: https://slanglane.com/esl

Abstract & Scope

Annual sociolinguistic and lexicographic report from the SlangLane Open Reference Corpus. Summarizes distribution across semantic categories, documents the rise of hyperbolic exhaustion markers (cooked, crash out) and algorithmic evasion (algospeak), and provides a citable reference index for journalists, university writing centers, and computational linguists.

Interactive Companion Tools on SlangLane.com

Slang Age & Brain-Rot Diagnostic Lab: https://slanglane.com/vibe-check

Corporate Email <-> Gen Z Group-Chat Translator: https://slanglane.com/roast

Court & HR Legal Exhibit Stamp Generator: https://slanglane.com/exhibit

5x5 Classroom & Meeting Slang Bingo: https://slanglane.com/bingo

Side-by-Side Usage Comparisons (A vs. B): https://slanglane.com/compare

Indexed Thematic Entries (79 Headwords, Edition daily-2026-10-21)

1. AFK - [Gaming | informal]

In plain English, "AFK": away from keyboard. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/afk

2. AI slop (aliases: slop, AI-generated slop) - [Digital culture | Critical derogatory]

Low-quality AI-generated material, especially output produced in volume with little concern for accuracy, coherence, or usefulness. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/ai-slop

3. algospeak (aliases: algo-speak, algorithm speak) - [Digital culture | Platform culture descriptive]

Altered words, spellings, euphemisms, or symbols people use because they believe platform algorithms may restrict the original wording. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/algospeak

4. ate (aliases: ate that, ate and left no crumbs, left no crumbs) - [Internet essentials | Enthusiastic praise]

Performed brilliantly, looked excellent, or completely delivered. "Ate and left no crumbs" intensifies the compliment. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/ate

5. aura (aliases: aura points, aura loss, negative aura) - [Internet essentials | Playful evaluative]

An impression of coolness, confidence, or striking presence. "Aura points" turn that impression into a joking, imaginary score. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/aura

6. aura farming (aliases: aura farm, aura farmer) - [Internet essentials | Admiring or teasing]

Cultivating an effortlessly cool image through a pose, gesture, performance, or carefully timed moment. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/aura-farming

7. banter (aliases: bants, bantering) - [Across the Atlantic | Playful relationship-dependent]

Playful, quick back-and-forth conversation, often involving teasing that the participants enjoy. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/banter

8. based - [Internet essentials | informal]

based: praiseworthy despite being unpopular or controversial. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/based

9. bet (aliases: aight bet) - [Internet essentials | Casual affirmative]

"Okay," "agreed," "sounds good," or "challenge accepted." The tone depends on what the speaker is responding to. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/bet

10. brain rot (aliases: brainrot, brain-rotted, brain rot content) - [Internet essentials | Critical or self-mocking]

Low-value, repetitive online content, or the feeling of being mentally saturated by it. Also a joking name for an intense fandom obsession. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/brain-rot

11. canon event (aliases: canon events) - [Social & memes | Storytelling metaphor often ironic]

A formative experience jokingly treated as an unavoidable part of someone's personal storyline, often embarrassing or difficult. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/canon-event

12. Chad - [Internet essentials | Admiring, ironic or status-focused]

An internet archetype of a highly attractive, sexually successful man; in a meme, the label can express exaggerated admiration or contrast. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/chad

13. cheers - [Across the Atlantic | Friendly informal]

A toast when drinking; also informal "thanks" or a friendly sign-off, especially in British and Irish English. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/cheers

14. chronically online (aliases: terminally online, extremely online) - [Digital culture | Critical or self-mocking]

So immersed in internet culture or disputes that your references, assumptions, or priorities seem disconnected from ordinary offline experience. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/chronically-online

15. chuffed (aliases: well chuffed, chuffed to bits) - [Across the Atlantic | Informal pleased]

Very pleased, proud, or delighted about something. "Chuffed to bits" is an especially enthusiastic version. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/chuffed

16. clickbait (aliases: click bait, click-bait) - [Social & memes | Critical publishing language]

A headline, thumbnail, or piece of content built to win clicks, often by withholding the point, exaggerating, or misleading. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/clickbait

17. cooked (aliases: we are cooked, i'm cooked, am I cooked) - [Internet essentials | Dramatic usually negative]

In serious trouble, exhausted, defeated, or beyond an easy fix. "Am I cooked?" asks whether the situation is hopeless. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/cooked

18. craic (aliases: the craic, what's the craic, good craic) - [Across the Atlantic | Informal social]

Enjoyable company, conversation, fun, or news. "What's the craic?" can mean "what's happening?" or "how are things?" | Regions: IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/craic

19. crash out - [Internet essentials | Anger-related slang / ambiguous]

To lose control in anger or act recklessly with serious consequences; separately, to fall asleep from exhaustion, fail or be eliminated. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/crash-out

20. cringe - [Internet essentials | context-dependent]

cringe: feel embarrassed, disgusted, or fearful. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/cringe

21. cringey - [Internet essentials | context-dependent]

In plain English, "cringey": embarrassing. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/cringey

22. dead internet theory (aliases: dead Internet theory) - [Digital culture | Theory / meme not established fact]

The idea that much online activity is automated or artificial rather than human; stronger versions make unsupported claims that most of the internet is fake. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/dead-internet-theory

23. delulu (aliases: delulu is the solulu) - [Internet essentials | Playful can be dismissive]

An exaggerated, informal version of "delusional": unrealistically hopeful, imagining a connection, or choosing confidence over the available evidence. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/delulu

24. doomscrolling (aliases: doomscroll, doom scrolling, doom-scrolling, doomscrolls) - [Social & memes | Informal digital habits]

Continuing to scroll through distressing news or negative posts, often longer than you intended. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/doomscrolling

25. eejit - [Across the Atlantic | pejorative]

A pejorative regional word for an idiot or fool, documented for Ireland and Scotland. | Regions: IE, UK | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/eejit

26. FR (aliases: fr, frfr, for real, for real for real) - [Texting shorthand | Casual sincere or questioning]

"For real": an emphasis on sincerity, a strong agreement, or a surprised question meaning "seriously?" | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/fr

27. FWIW - [Texting shorthand | informal]

In plain English, "FWIW": for what it's worth. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/fwiw

28. GG - [Gaming | informal]

In plain English, "GG": good game. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/gg

29. ghosting (aliases: ghosted, ghost someone) - [People & relationships | Informal relationships and contact]

Ending or abandoning an ongoing connection by stopping communication without an explanation. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/ghosting

30. glazing (aliases: glaze) - [Internet essentials | Disapproving or self-mocking praise label]

Giving someone or something excessive praise; the label suggests the admiration is over the top, unwarranted or annoying. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/glazing

31. goated - [Internet essentials | informal praise]

A slang description for someone or something considered the greatest of all time or the best. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/goated

32. gobsmacked - [Across the Atlantic | informal]

gobsmacked: utterly astonished and speechless. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/gobsmacked

33. grand (aliases: that is grand, that's grand, I'm grand) - [Across the Atlantic | Informal reassuring]

In Irish English, often "fine," "okay," or "no problem." It does not necessarily mean magnificent or unusually impressive. | Regions: IE, UK | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/grand

34. green flag (aliases: green flags, greenflag) - [People & relationships | Approving reassuring]

An encouraging sign that someone or something may be trustworthy, compatible, or worth pursuing. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/green-flag

35. gutted - [Across the Atlantic | Informal deeply disappointed]

Very disappointed, upset, or crushed by an unwelcome result. Often used for a loss, cancellation, or missed opportunity. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/gutted

36. highkey (aliases: high-key, high key, highk) - [Internet essentials | Emphatic openly stated]

"Really," "openly," or "without trying to play it down." It turns an opinion or feeling into a more direct declaration. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/highkey

37. ick (aliases: the ick) - [People & relationships | Informal aversion]

A feeling or expression of disgust or aversion. "The ick" can describe a reaction that makes someone suddenly feel put off. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/ick

38. ICYMI - [Texting shorthand | internet slang]

ICYMI expands to 'in case you missed it,' introducing information for a reader who may have missed it. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/icymi

39. IDK - [Texting shorthand | informal]

In plain English, "IDK": I don't know. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/idk

40. IMO - [Texting shorthand | informal]

In plain English, "IMO": in my opinion. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/imo

41. IYKYK (aliases: if you know you know, iykyk) - [Texting shorthand | Knowing inside reference]

"If you know, you know": a signal that people with the shared experience or background will understand an unstated reference. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/iykyk

42. locked in (aliases: lock in, locking in, locked-in) - [Internet essentials | Focused motivational]

Fully focused and committed to a task. "Time to lock in" means it is time to stop distractions and concentrate. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/locked-in

43. looksmaxxing - [Internet essentials | Appearance-focused community vocabulary]

Trying to improve physical appearance, especially within online communities that frame attractiveness as a competitive status or dating advantage. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/looksmaxxing

44. lore (aliases: lore drop, personal lore) - [Social & memes | Storytelling often playful]

The background story and accumulated details of a fictional world, community, or person. A "lore drop" reveals a new piece of that backstory. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/lore

45. love bombing - [People & relationships | context-dependent]

love bombing: manipulative over affection tactic. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/love-bombing

46. lowkey (aliases: low-key, low key, lowk, lwk) - [Internet essentials | Understated informal]

"Kind of," "quietly," or "I am admitting this without making a big deal of it." A low-key event is also relaxed or understated. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/lowkey

47. main character energy (aliases: main-character energy) - [Social & memes | Admiring or critical]

A confident, cinematic sense of being the protagonist of the moment; sometimes a criticism of acting as if everyone else is a supporting character. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/main-character-energy

48. mate (aliases: mates) - [Across the Atlantic | Familiar tone-sensitive]

A friend or a familiar way to address someone. It can sound warm, neutral, sarcastic, or confrontational depending on delivery. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/mate

49. mewing - [Internet essentials | Appearance-trend vocabulary / ambiguous]

A tongue-posture practice pursued with the aim of changing jaw or facial appearance; also the ordinary act of making a mew sound. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/mewing

50. mid - [Internet essentials | Dismissive evaluative]

Mediocre, underwhelming, or not worth the hype. Usually a criticism, even though it literally suggests the middle. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/mid

51. mogging - [Internet essentials | Comparative / appearance-ranking slang]

Outshining or appearing superior to someone, especially in perceived physical attractiveness; a subjective comparison rather than an objective score. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/mogging

52. no cap (aliases: nocap, no capping) - [Internet essentials | Informal emphatic]

"Honestly," "for real," or "I am not exaggerating." Cap means a lie or an exaggeration in this slang context. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/no-cap

53. OMW - [Texting shorthand | informal]

In plain English, "OMW": on my way. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/omw

54. pookie - [People & relationships | Affectionate, cutesy or playful]

An affectionate name for a loved person, such as a partner, friend or relative; as an address, roughly sweetheart or darling. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/pookie

55. POV (aliases: point of view, pov) - [Texting shorthand | Perspective scenario framing]

"Point of view." In captions, it usually introduces a situation the viewer is invited to imagine experiencing. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/pov

56. proper - [Across the Atlantic | colloquial]

A UK and Irish colloquial use of proper as an adverb meaning thoroughly or completely. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/proper

57. rage bait (aliases: ragebait, rage-bait, rage baiting) - [Social & memes | Critical media language]

Content designed to provoke anger so people will react, argue, share, or keep watching. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/rage-bait

58. ratio (aliases: ratioed, ratio'd, ratioing) - [Social & memes | Combative platform-dependent]

A social-media response showing stronger pushback than approval, or a reply that gets more support than the post it challenges. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/ratio

59. red flag (aliases: red flags, redflag) - [People & relationships | Warning sometimes exaggerated]

A warning sign that something may be wrong or deserves closer attention, especially in a relationship or decision. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/red-flag

60. rent-free (aliases: rent free, living rent-free, lives rent free) - [Social & memes | Teasing sometimes dismissive]

Occupying someone's thoughts without effort or invitation, usually in "living rent-free in my head." It can describe delight, annoyance, or fixation. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/rent-free

61. rizz (aliases: rizz up, rizzing, rizzed, unspoken rizz) - [Internet essentials | Playful usually flattering]

Charm or the ability to attract someone, especially through flirting. To "rizz someone up" is to try to win them over. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/rizz

62. scroll fatigue - [Digital culture | Emerging informal]

A feeling of being mentally worn out by prolonged scrolling through feeds or other online material. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/scroll-fatigue

63. side quest (aliases: sidequest, side quests) - [Social & memes | Playful gaming metaphor]

An optional detour from the main objective in a game, or a spontaneous little adventure away from your original plan in everyday life. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/side-quest

64. sigma - [Internet essentials | Ironic or status-focused internet language]

A self-sufficient lone-wolf male archetype; also praise meaning excellent, or a deliberately absurd word in memes such as "what the sigma." | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/sigma

65. simp - [Internet essentials | Derogatory or self-mocking]

Someone accused of excessive devotion or deference to another person; as a verb, to admire or praise in an exaggerated, deferential way. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/simp

66. situationship (aliases: situationships) - [People & relationships | Informal dating language]

A romantic connection whose status, expectations, or commitment have not been clearly defined. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/situationship

67. six seven (aliases: 67, 6-7, 6 7, six-seven) - [Internet essentials | Absurdist context-dependent]

A meme expression usually said "six seven," often with a balancing hand gesture. It has no single fixed literal meaning. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/six-seven

68. skibidi - [Internet essentials | Absurd meme language]

A deliberately nonsensical meme word used for humorous effect, reactions or references to internet slang; it has no single dependable plain-English meaning. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/skibidi

69. slay (aliases: slayed, slaying) - [Internet essentials | Enthusiastic approving]

To do something impressively well or look excellent. "Slay!" is an enthusiastic expression of approval. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/slay

70. soft launch (aliases: soft-launch, soft launching, soft-launched) - [People & relationships | Social media indirect reveal]

Hinting at a romantic relationship online without clearly identifying the partner or explicitly announcing the relationship. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/soft-launch

71. sound (aliases: sound person, sound as) - [Across the Atlantic | Informal approving]

Decent, reliable, friendly, or good. As a short reply, "sound" can mean "okay," "agreed," or an appreciative acknowledgment. | Regions: UK, IE | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/sound

72. sus (aliases: sussy) - [Internet essentials | Suspicious often joking]

Suspicious, questionable, or not quite trustworthy. It can be a genuine concern or a playful reaction to odd behavior. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/sus

73. tasteslop (aliases: taste slop) - [Digital culture | Emerging critical]

A critical label for AI-generated style or lifestyle content that appears tasteful and curated but feels generic, derivative, or empty. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/tasteslop

74. TBH - [Texting shorthand | informal]

In plain English, "TBH": to be honest. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/tbh

75. TL;DR (aliases: tl;dr, TLDR, tldr, too long didnt read, too long; didn't read) - [Texting shorthand | Concise sometimes dismissive]

"Too long; didn't read." It can dismiss a long message, but is also a common label for a short summary supplied by the writer. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/tldr

76. touch grass (aliases: touching grass, touched grass, go touch grass) - [Social & memes | Teasing often dismissive]

Step away from the internet and regain some real-world perspective. Often a dismissive response to an overly online argument. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/touch-grass

77. unc - [Internet essentials | Affectionate or teasing age-related slang]

A shortening of uncle; also a teasing label for an older man or somebody seen as out of touch with current youth culture. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/unc

78. vibe coding (aliases: vibe code, vibe-coded, vibecoding) - [Digital culture | Technical culture debated scope]

Building software by repeatedly prompting an AI and reacting to the result, especially when the person pays little attention to the underlying code. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/vibe-coding

79. W (aliases: w) - [Internet essentials | internet slang]

In internet slang, W abbreviates win: a success or winning result. | Regions: Online | Canonical entry: https://slanglane.com/terms/w